THE FULL PITCH · VERSION 2

NUT SORT

More ways to play.
Still not one ad.

Daily challenge · Mystery nuts · Tall bolts · Birthday theme · Streaks · Hints · Themes · Stats

Black and gold. Original nut colours. Every screen designed.

CREATED BY
Kiaran

Mock-ups drawn from real, verified game boards.



EVERYTHING ADDED SINCE THE FIRST PITCH

What’s new in version 2.

1 Group moves

Move a whole same-colour run in one smooth go, as far as there is room.

2 Mystery nuts

Nuts under the top one are hidden until you move what’s above.

3 Tall bolts

Boards with few stacks up to 9 high, as well as wide packed ones.

4 Daily challenge

One extra-hard board a day for 3× stars. 70 verified boards ready.

5 Streaks + freeze

Beat the daily to build a streak. A freeze protects one missed day.

6 Date chip

Today’s date on the home page. Tap it for the daily challenge.

7 Birthday theme

Every 15 March: bunting, balloons, a greeting for you and bonus stars.

8 Hint button

Shows one good move, three times a level. No ads, no videos.

9 Stars buy themes

Spend stars on themes. Stars become something to aim for.

10 Stats page

Streaks, perfect solves, nuts sorted and progress by difficulty.

11 Smooth motion + sound

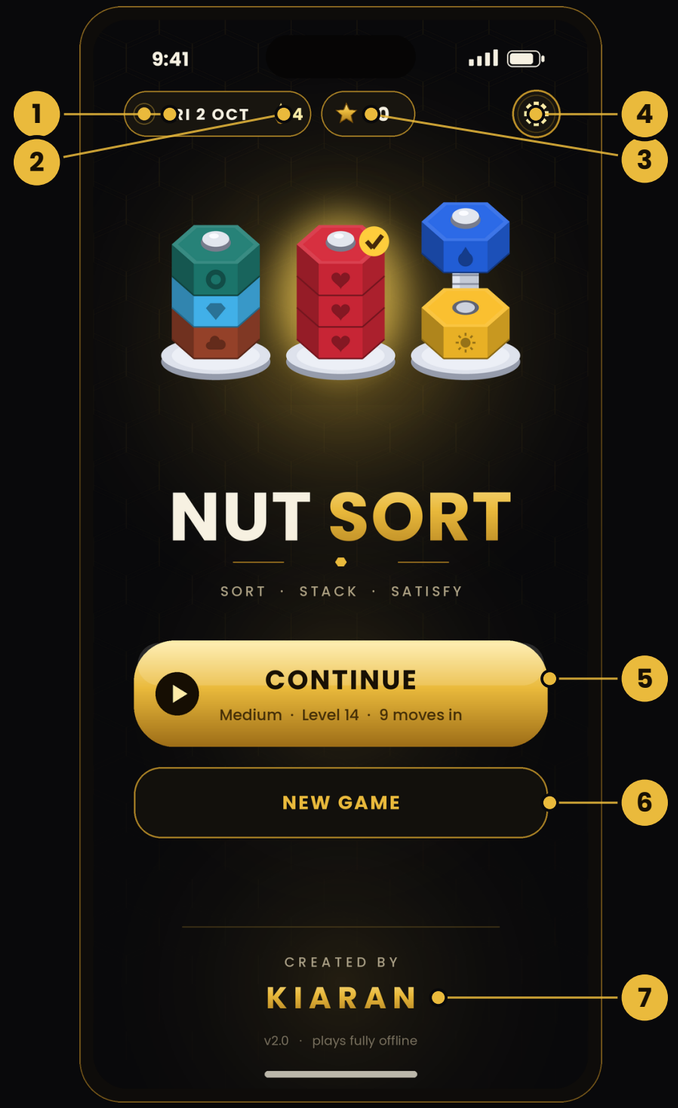
Quick, calm animation and sounds generated on the phone.

12 Re-tuned ladders

Easy, Medium and Hard re-measured with the new rules.

SCREEN · HOME

A home page with a date and a streak.



1. **Date chip**
   Today's date. A gold dot means today's daily challenge is still to do; a tick means done. Tap it to open the challenge.
2. **Streak**
   The flame and number show your daily-challenge streak.
3. **Star total**
   Tap to open stats and themes.
4. **Settings**
   Sound, motion, birthday preview and backup.
5. **Continue**
   Only appears when a level is unfinished.
6. **New game**
   Opens the difficulty chooser.
7. **Creator credit**
   "Created by Kiaran" at the foot of the page.

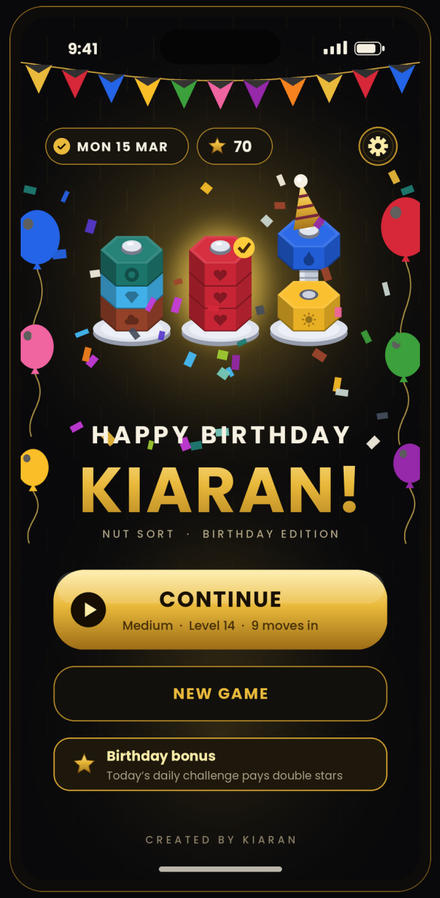
FIRST LAUNCH



No saved game and no streak yet, so the gold button is Play and the flame is hidden.

BIRTHDAY THEME

Every 15 March, it’s yours.



Home page



Greeting, shown once



In play

How it works

- The app checks the phone’s local date. On 15 March, every year, the theme switches on by itself. In 2027 that is a Monday.
- Bunting across the top, balloons at the sides, a party hat on the lifted nut, and confetti on every level complete.
- A greeting appears the first time you open the app that day: “Happy Birthday, Kiaran!”
- Birthday bonus (my idea): the daily challenge pays double stars on the day.
- Settings has “Preview birthday theme” so you can see it, and test it, any day of the year.
- Everything else stays black and gold. Nut colours don’t change.

SCREENS · DAILY, RESULT AND STREAK SAVED

The daily challenge.



Today's challenge



Result



Streak freeze used

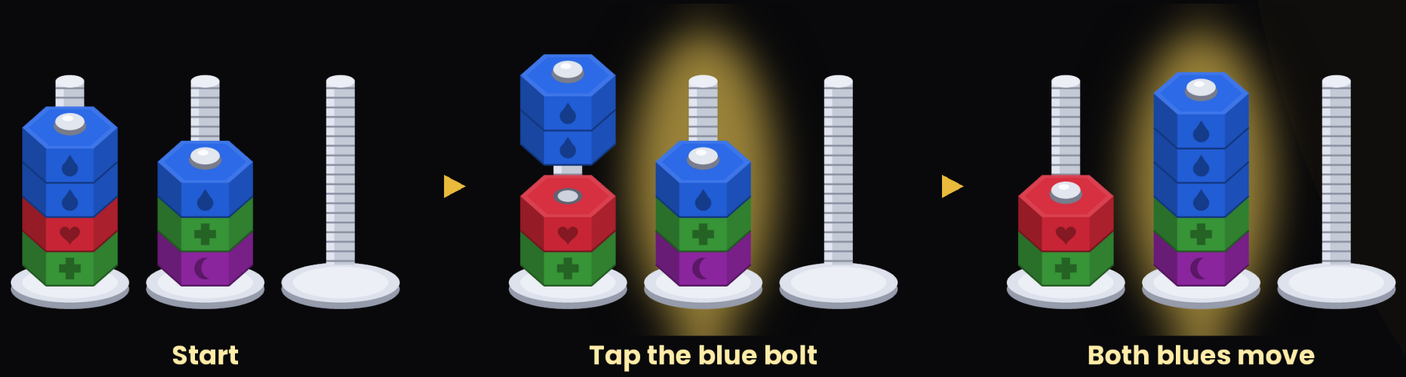
The rules

- One board a day, the same for the whole day. It resets at midnight on the phone's clock.
- Harder than Hard: par 75–108 moves, against 48–86 on the Hard ladder. Five shapes rotate: packed, wide and tall, mystery, giant tall, tall mystery.
- Worth 3× stars (3, 6 or 9), plus a streak bonus of one star per streak day, up to +10.
- A streak freeze is earned every 7 days (you can hold 2). Missing one day uses one automatically. Missing two or more resets the streak.
- Streaks use the phone's clock, which is fine for a personal game.

28.4 KB holds all 70 boards.

RULE 1 · MOVING COLOURS

Group moves.



Start | Tap the blue bolt | Both blues move

Room for both: the whole run moves together.



Only 1 slot free | Tap the blue bolt | Only 1 blue moves

Room for one: only one nut moves, the other stays.

The rule

- Tap a bolt: the whole top run of one colour lifts, then lands on an empty bolt or one with the same colour on top.
- It moves as many as fit. Room for 3, a run of 2: both move. Room for 1: one moves.
- Animation: the run lifts, glides and drops together, with a tiny stagger.
- You can't choose to move fewer. That keeps it simple and quick.

What it does to difficulty

Boards get 14–28% shorter (measured):

8 colours × 3	**21 to 18 moves**
12 colours × 4	**54 to 39 moves**
15 colours × 3	**42 to 35 moves**

RULE 2 · HIDDEN NUTS

Mystery nuts.





Hidden until the nut above moves.



Hidden nuts never join a group.

The rules

- Grey nuts with a ? are hidden. A hidden nut shows its colour once the nut above it moves away.
- Only the visible top run can move as a group. A nut revealed by a move doesn't join that same move.
- Undo puts the hidden nuts back, so you can't peek by moving and undoing (my recommendation).
- Where: Medium every 5th level from level 10 (half the bolts); Hard every 3rd level from level 6 (every bolt).
- Stars are looser on mystery levels: 3 stars at 150% of par, 2 stars at 200%. Par assumes you can see everything.
- Every test board stayed solvable; hiding nuts added only 1–6 moves to the best solution.

RULE 3 · FEW STACKS, UP TO 9 HIGH

Tall bolts.



How many bolts fit on screen

Nuts must stay at least 31 px wide so every bolt is an easy tap.

Bolt height	Max bolts
3–5	35
6–7	28
8–10	21
12	14

Tested shapes (2 spare bolts)

4 stacks × 9 high	36 nuts	**26 moves**
6 stacks × 9	54 nuts	**45 moves**
8 stacks × 9	72 nuts	**62 moves**
10 stacks × 9	90 nuts	**81 moves**

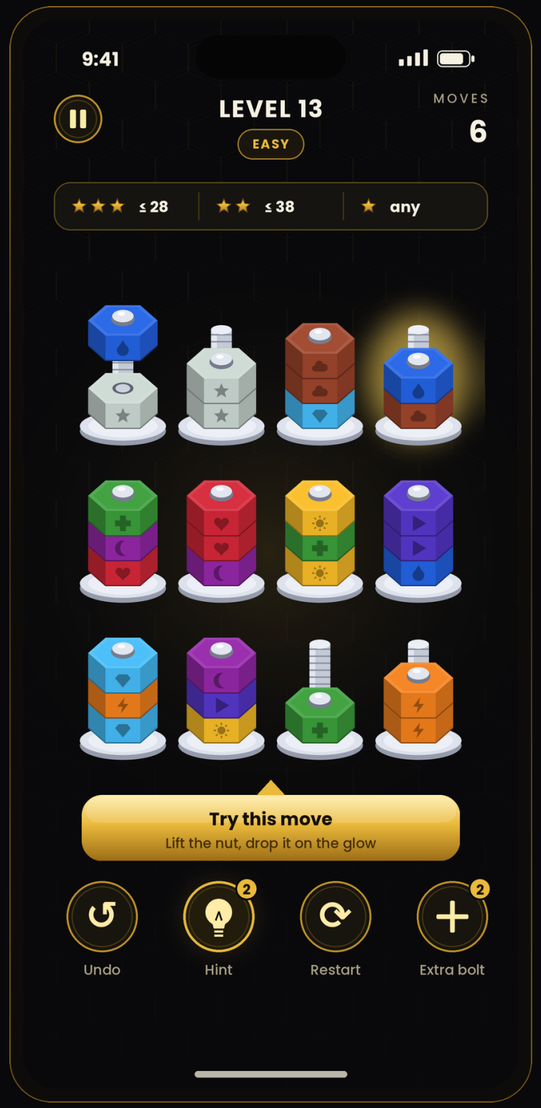
Few stacks isn't automatically hard: 4 × 9 takes only 26 moves. Hard tall levels use 8 or more stacks.

The board rules

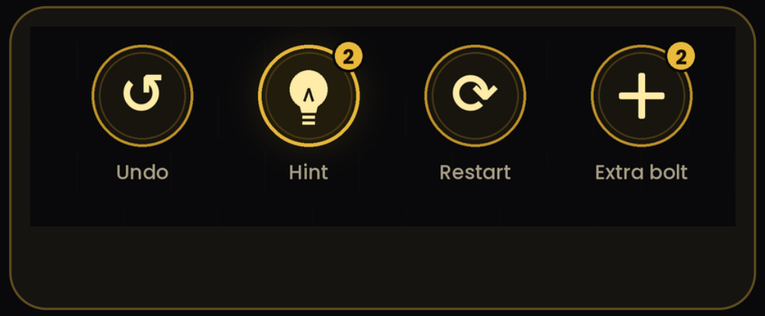
- Colours (stacks): 4 to 18. Nuts per colour: 3 to 9.
- Spare bolts: always 2 or more. With only 1 spare, none of my 6 test boards could be solved.
- Total nuts: up to 90 on the ladders and up to 108 on the daily challenge.
- Bolts on screen can never exceed the table, so a 9-high board has at most 21 bolts.
- The level builder picks a shape for each rung: packed, balanced, or tall.
- The 12 × 9 board in the daily challenge has 14 bolts and 108 nuts.

IDEA · A FRIENDLY NUDGE

Hint button.



1. **Undo**
   Takes back the last move, including any hidden nuts it revealed.
2. **Hint**
   Lifts one nut and glows its landing bolt. The badge shows hints left.
3. **Restart**
   Starts the level again.
4. **Extra bolt**
   A free spare bolt. The badge shows how many are left.
5. **Hint bubble**
   Tells you what to try.

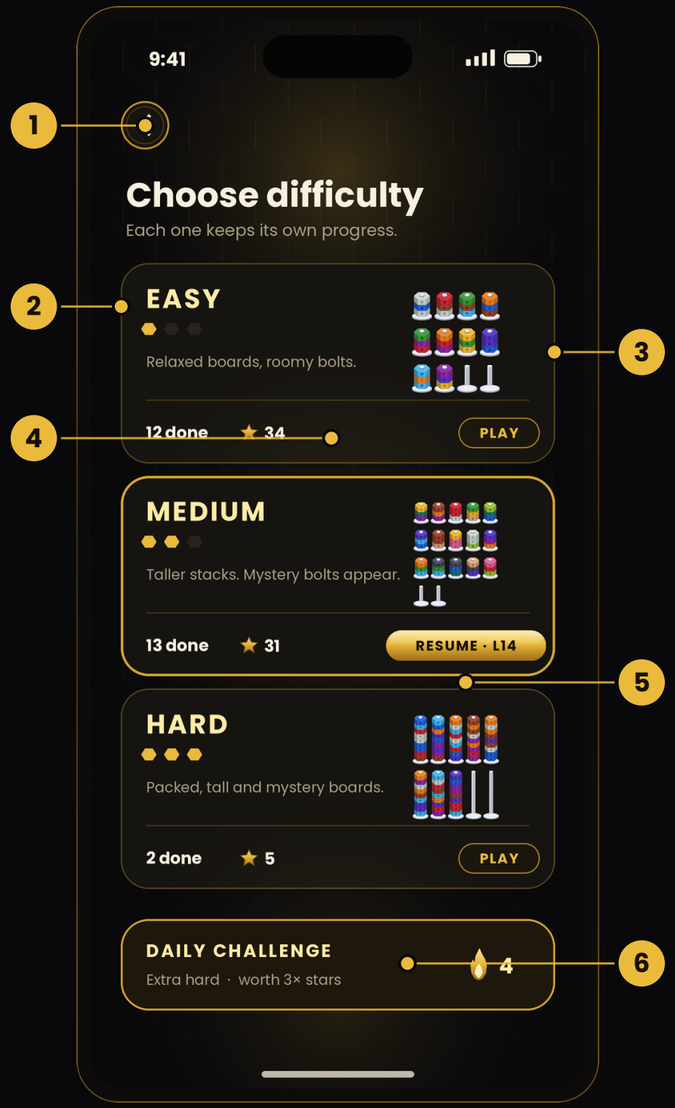


How hints work

- 3 hints a level (1 on mystery levels). They're free: no ads, no videos.
- A hint move counts as a normal move, so it doesn't change your stars.
- The hint comes from the same solver that checks every level.
- If you've wandered off the planned route, it solves again from where you are. On the biggest boards that could take a few seconds, so it runs in the background.

SCREEN · CHOOSE DIFFICULTY

Three difficulties, plus the daily.



1. **Back**
   Returns to the home page.
2. **Difficulty**
   Three gold hexagons show how hard each one is.
3. **Board preview**
   A real board from that difficulty.
4. **Progress**
   Levels done and stars, kept separately for each.
5. **Resume**
   The one with an unfinished game gets a gold border.
6. **Daily challenge**
   Always one tap away, with your streak.

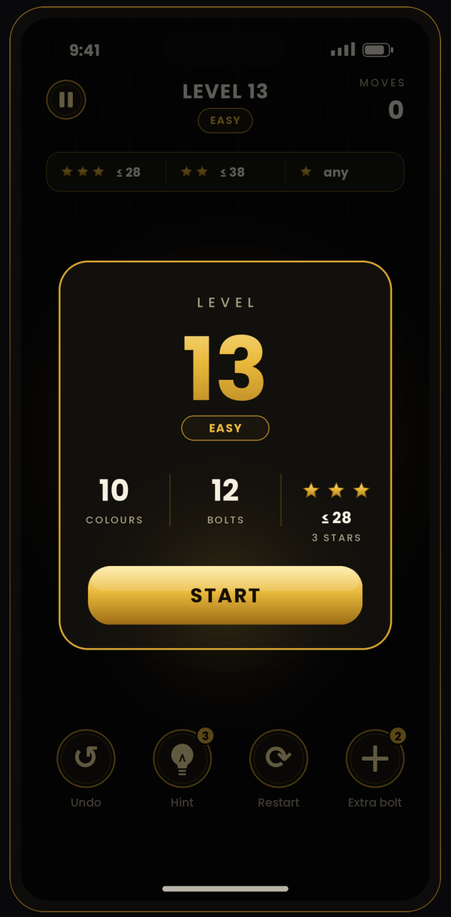
What changes between them

	Easy	Medium	Hard
Colours	6–12	6–15	8–18
Nuts per bolt	3–5	3–7	4–9
Bolts	9–14	8–17	10–20
Spare bolts	2–3	2	2
Mystery levels	none	1 in 5	1 in 3

From the new 30-level ladders, measured with group moves on.

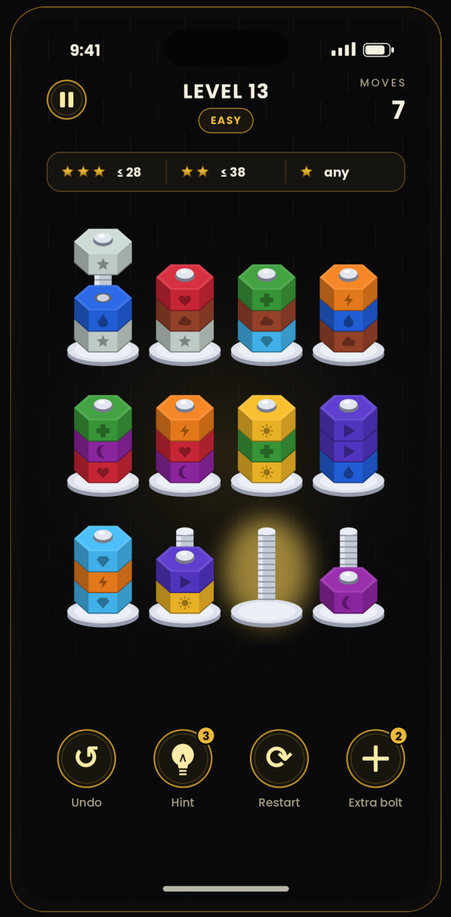
SCREENS · A LEVEL FROM START TO COMPLETION

Easy level: start, play, finish.



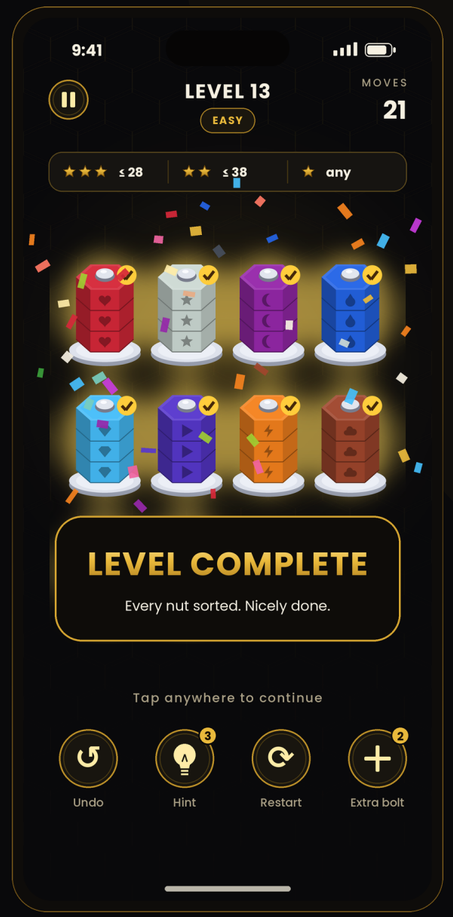
1 · Level intro

Colours, bolts and the 3-star target. Tap START.



2 · Playing

The lifted nut and gold glow show where it can land.



3 · Complete

Gold checks, confetti, then the star screen.

On Easy level 13

10 colours

12 bolts, 2 spare

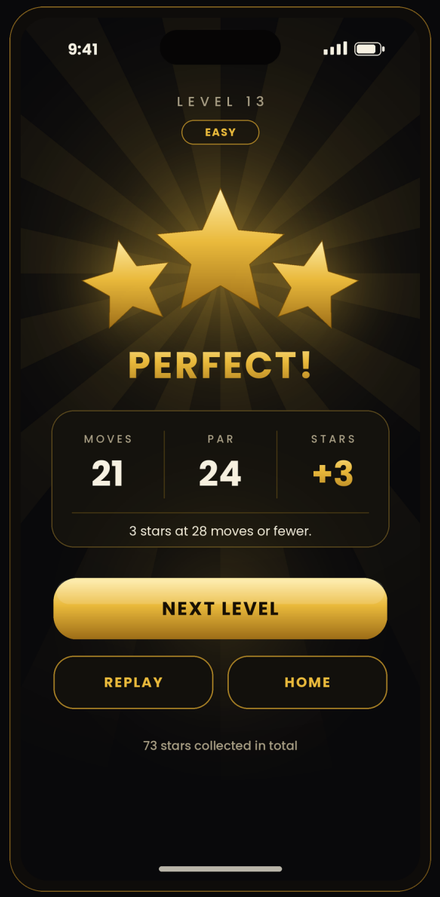
24 moves is par

3 stars at 28 moves or fewer, 2 stars at 38.

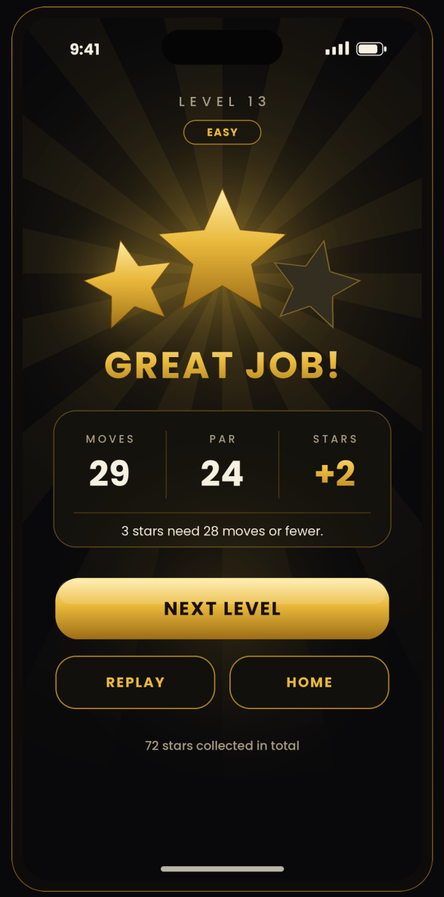
No timer. No penalties. Stuck? Undo, hint, add a bolt or restart.

SCREEN · RESULT

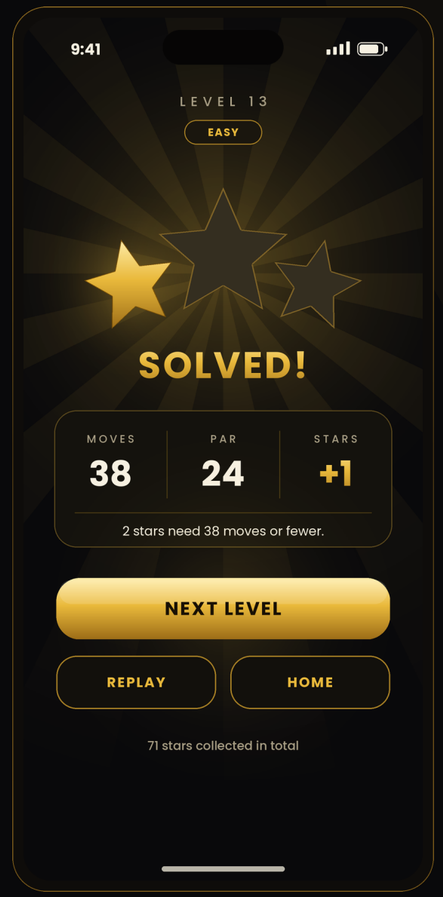
The star rating screen.



3 stars · 21 moves



2 stars · 29 moves



1 star · 38 moves

Same Easy level 13 each time. Par is 24 moves.

How stars are earned

★★★ **within 120% of par**
At par 24: 28 moves or fewer

★★☆ **within 160% of par**
At par 24: 38 moves or fewer

★☆☆ **any finish**
At par 24: always

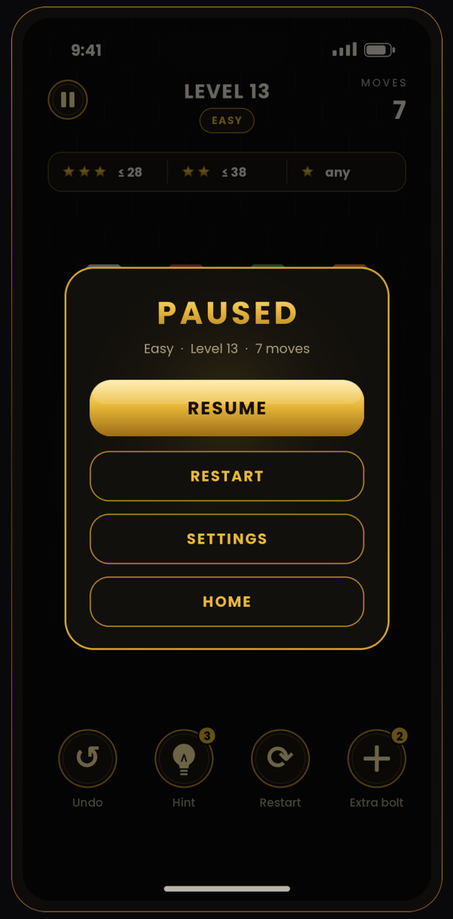
Mystery levels use 150% and 200%. The daily challenge pays 3×, so 3, 6 or 9 stars.

Par is the solution length for that exact board, found by my test solver. A sharp human can beat it.

These percentages are a starting point. We'll tune them once you've played a few levels.

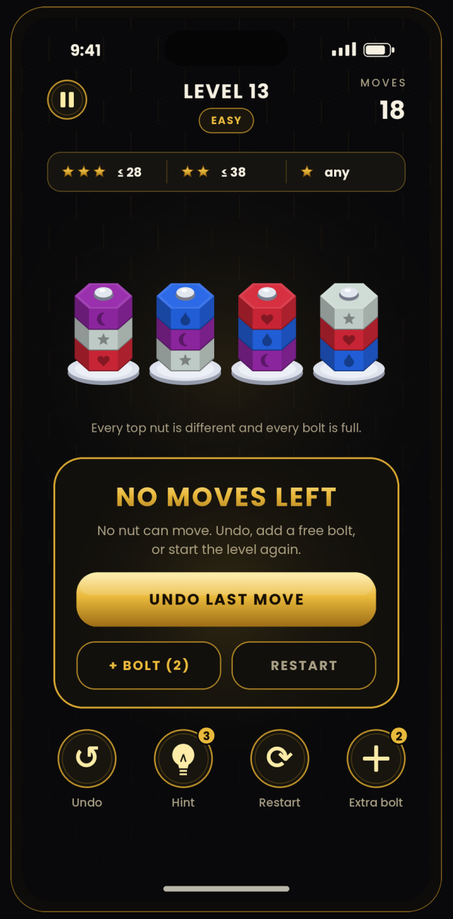
SCREENS · THE REST OF THE PLAY INTERFACE

Pause, stuck and settings.



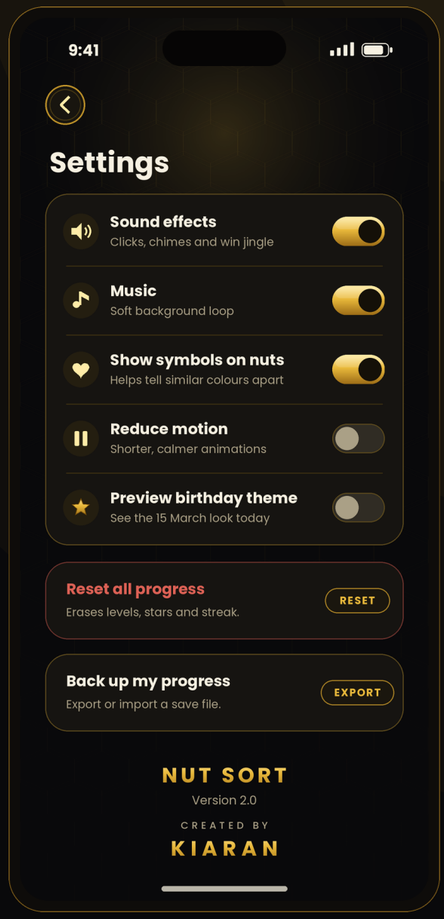
Pause

Resume, restart, settings or home.



No moves left

Appears on its own. Undo, use a bolt or restart.



Settings

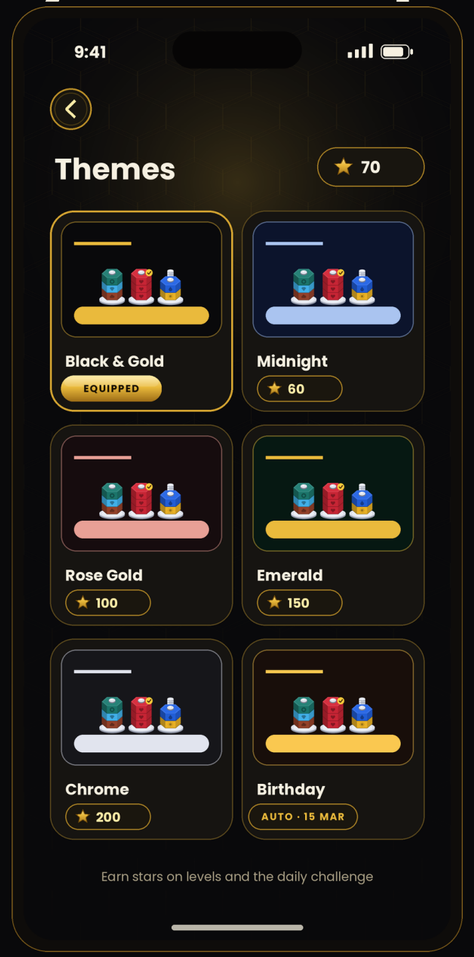
Sound, motion, birthday preview, backup and reset.

SCREENS · STATS AND THEMES

Stats, and stars you can spend.



Stats



Themes

Stars become something to aim for

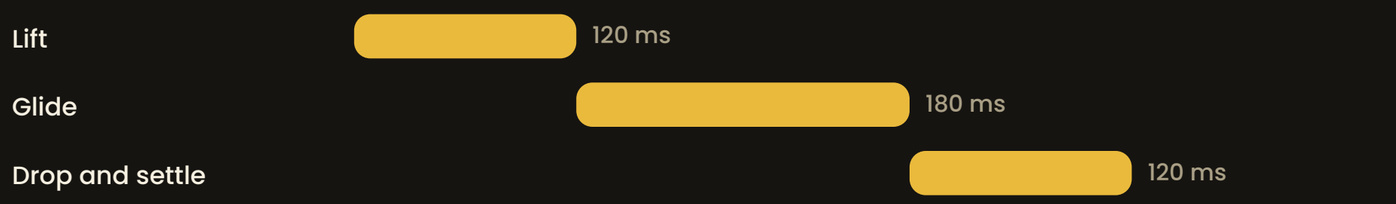
- Tap the star total on the home page to open Stats; Themes is one tap from there.
- Themes are spent with stars: Midnight 60, Rose Gold 100, Emerald 150, Chrome 200 (sample prices).
- Black & Gold is the default. The Birthday theme can’t be bought: it switches on every 15 March.
- Stats: levels solved, perfect solves, nuts sorted, best streak, dailies beaten, average stars, and solved by difficulty.
- Backup (in Settings) exports your progress, so clearing Safari data doesn’t lose it.

All numbers on these screens are sample data.

MOTION AND SOUND · TARGETS TO TUNE ON YOUR PHONE

Smooth and quick, never slow.

One nut moving (about 0.42 s)



Run of 3 nuts: each extra nut starts 40 ms later



Other motion

Finished bolt: gold pulse	**250 ms**
Mystery reveal: grey to colour	**180 ms**
Level complete: confetti	**about 1.5 s**

Feel and sound

- You can tap your next move while an animation is still finishing. Nothing makes you wait.
- Reduce motion (in Settings, and respecting the iPhone setting) swaps the movement for quick fades.
- Sounds are generated by the phone: a click on lift, a clunk on drop, a chime on a finished bolt, a short fanfare on a win, a birthday jingle on 15 March.
- No audio files, so the app stays small and works offline.
- I can’t hear or feel it from here. We’ll tune the timings together once it runs on your phone.

HOW LEVELS REACH YOUR PHONE

Pre-loaded, not made up on the spot.

1 Seed

Every board comes from a number. The same number always gives the same board.

2 Shuffle and solve

On your Mac, each board is shuffled and solved by a checker.

3 Keep or bin

Unsolvable boards are thrown away. The rest ship inside the app.

The phone never has to solve anything, so levels open instantly and offline.

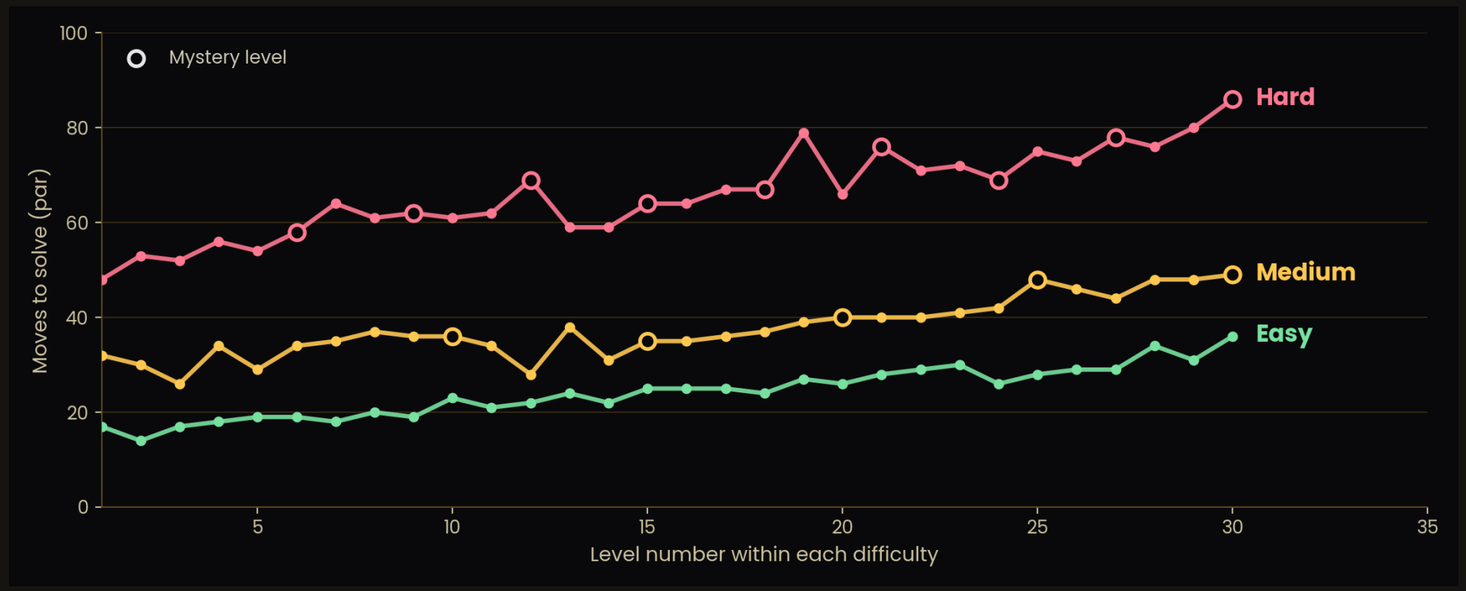
What's built

28.4 KB
holds the 70 daily boards (a full year is about 150 KB)

23 of 93
daily shuffles were thrown away as unsolvable

90 of 90
ladder levels (30 per difficulty) built and solved

Several min
to build the 70 dailies on my Mac. The daily pool takes the longest.

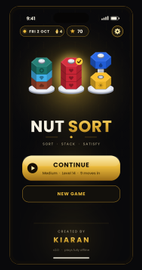


The re-tuned ladders, measured with group moves on. Hollow dots are mystery levels.

Easy 14–36 moves. Medium 26–49. Hard 48–86. The daily is 75–108.

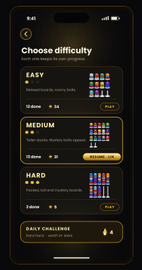
NAVIGATION MAP

How the screens connect.



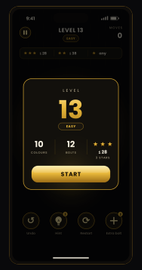
Home

New game ▶



Difficulty

pick one ▶



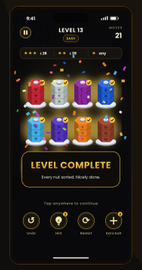
Level intro

Start ▶



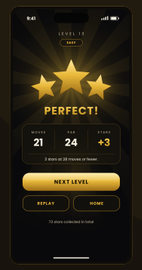
Playing

last bolt ▶



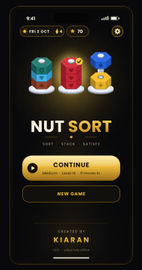
Complete

tap ▶



Stars

DAILY, FROM THE DATE CHIP



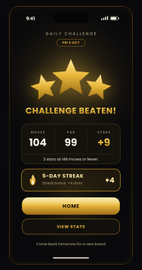
Date chip

tap ▶



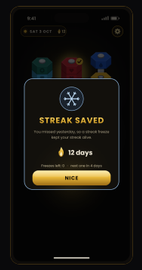
Daily

beat it ▶



Result

missed a day ▶

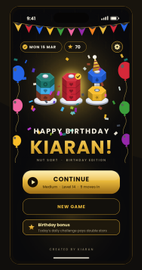


Streak saved

BIRTHDAY, EVERY 15 MARCH

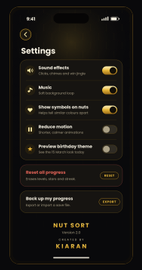


Greeting



15 Mar home

SIDE SCREENS



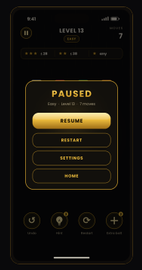
Settings



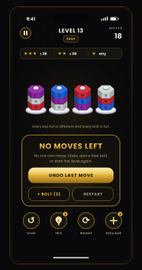
Stats



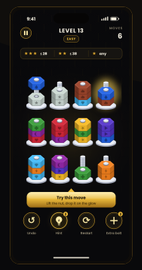
Themes



Pause



No moves



Hint

Settings opens from the gear and from Pause. Stats and Themes open from the star total. Hint, Pause and No moves appear while playing.

SAY GO TO START BUILDING

Decisions, and what's next.

My defaults. Change any you don't like.

Group moves
always move the maximum that fits

Mystery undo
undo restores hidden nuts

Mystery stars
3 stars at 150% of par, 2 stars at 200%

Hints
3 a level, 1 on mystery levels, free

Streak freeze
1 per 7-day streak, hold up to 2

Daily stars
3×, plus streak bonus up to +10

Birthday
2× daily stars on 15 March (my idea)

Theme prices
60, 100, 150, 200 stars (sample)

Spare bolts
never fewer than 2

Name
Nut Sort, for now

The look

Black	Panel	Gold
#09090B	#161411	#EABA3C

Light gold	Ivory	Muted
#FFECA8	#F7F1E2	#AAA086

Poppins Bold and Medium. Nut colours unchanged.

Say "Go"

and I'll write the Claude Code starter prompt for the whole build, with this PDF as the spec.

Created by Kiaran